

You need JavaScript enabled to use this service.

## Cookies on Civil Service Jobs

We'd like to use analytics cookies so we can understand how you use Civil Service Jobs and make improvements.

We also use essential cookies to remember if you've accepted analytics cookies.

2c01acfa1fc75552508750acaf044250.17906

Accept analytics cookies

Reject analytics cookies

1790664151-4cbf54c5bac206dfbc5cd01550b

|                                        |
|----------------------------------------|
| change                                 |
| Language                               |
| 121                                    |
| BQsDAAAABgoBMQAAAApzZWFyY2hwYWdlO      |
| 1224                                   |
| yes                                    |
| 1790664151-4cbf54c5bac206dfbc5cd01550b |

# Deputy Director for Government Cyber Services and Deputy Government CISO

Department for Science, Innovation & Technology

**Apply before 11:55 pm on Monday 12th October 2026**



Department for  
Science, Innovation  
& Technology

**Reference number**

482948

**Salary**

£86,000 - £117,800

Existing Civil Servants applying on promotion will be appointed to the salary band minimum or with an increase of 10% of their existing salary, whichever is greater. Individuals appointed on level transfer will retain their existing salary. Standard pay rules apply for existing civil servants. External candidates are expected to start on the pay band minimum.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

**Job grade**

SCS Pay Band 1

**Contract type**

Fixed term

Loan

Secondment

**Length of employment**

12 months

**Business area**

Government Cyber Unit

**Type of role**

Senior leadership

Other

**Working pattern**

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share

**Number of jobs available**

1

## Contents

### Location

About the job

Benefits

Things you need to know

Apply and further information

## Location

This role is based in London. Travel will be required occasionally.

## About the job

### **Job summary**

We are looking for an experienced and senior cyber security or digital and data professional to lead the Government Cyber Services team and support the Government CISO as one of the Deputy Government CISO s. In this role you will be responsible for ensuring that central cyber capabilities are prioritised, designed, and adopted in ways that deliver measurable impact at scale. This role reports to the Director for the Government Cyber Unit.

As the Government Cyber Unit, our mission is to protect public services and the wider Government from cyber threats and non-malicious technology failures. The Government Cyber Action Plan (GCAP) sets out our approach to delivering this mission by achieving a radical shift in the pace of cyber and digital resilience transformation. We are responsible for delivering the central initiatives defined in the GCAP, as well as managing government-wide cyber risk on behalf of the DCMS Permanent Secretary. You will play a key role in government cyber security, taking decisions that affect the breadth of government and driving strategic improvement and change. You will need to be a confident, inspiring and inclusive leader, committed to the support and development of your staff.

### **Job description**

Lead Government Cyber Services as the central service function for GCAP delivery, setting direction for a coherent portfolio of scalable cyber services

that are delivered once and well, meet user needs, and improve cyber and digital resilience across government and the wider public sector. The role is accountable for delivery across the following core areas:

**Set the cyber services strategy and portfolio:**

Define and maintain the Government Cyber Services portfolio, ensuring central services are prioritised against GCAP objectives, government-wide cyber risk, user need, and measurable security outcomes.

Establish clear service ownership, roadmaps, standards and success measures so that services are coherent, scalable, value for money, and aligned to the wider Government Cyber Action Plan operating model.

**Coordinate access, adoption and demand:**

Ensure government organisations can identify, access and adopt the right cyber services through clear routes to support, effective engagement, and practical implementation pathways.

Shape demand across departments and the wider public sector, using evidence of risk, maturity and need to prioritise interventions where central services can deliver the greatest system-wide impact.

**Develop services once and well:**

Lead the design, development and continuous improvement of common cyber services, products and technical capabilities that address common problems and reduce duplication across government.

Embed user-centred, evidence-led and secure-by-design delivery practices, ensuring services are usable, technically credible, operationally sustainable and capable of being adopted at scale.

**Measure impact and manage performance:**

Put in place portfolio-level performance, benefits and risk reporting that demonstrates whether services are improving resilience, reducing exposure and supporting GCAP delivery milestones.

Use operational insight, service data and feedback from departments to refine priorities, address delivery blockers and hold service owners to account for outcomes, quality and adoption.

## **Influence the wider cyber system:**

Work with departments, central functions, NCSC and other partners to ensure cyber services complement accountability, support, response and skills activity across GCAP.

Represent the cyber services agenda with senior stakeholders, building confidence in the central offer and securing the collaboration needed to drive adoption across organisational boundaries.

## **The role-holder will also:**

Act as a core member of GCU leadership team, providing input and challenge to strategic direction.

Be an advocate for excellence in all things relating to leadership and people management.

Deputise for the Director of the Government Cyber Unit as required.

Participate in out-of-hours cover.

## **Person specification**

### **Essential criteria**

We're interested in people who have:

Proven and excellent leadership skills to inspire, empower and motivate others.

Significant experience delivering cyber security solutions or digital, data and technology services at a large organisational, public sector or national level.

Compelling communication and influencing skills with a strong focus on relationship building, including the ability to clearly and simply explain technical details to non-technical audiences, and engage with senior stakeholders.

An ability to form strong working relationships, influence senior stakeholders, and drive coordinated action across multiple organisations with different incentives, priorities and levels of cyber maturity.

Proven experience of driving transformation across organisational boundaries to improve delivery, impact and performance.

Significant experience building, developing, and managing diverse and high-performing teams

**It is desirable that you have:**

Experience of working in national security or related environments.

Experience working with and leading digital development teams that adhere to the Service Standard

An in-depth understanding of cyber threats, vulnerabilities and mitigations.

**Behaviours**

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Leadership

Delivering at Pace

Making Effective Decisions

Changing and Improving

## Benefits

Alongside your salary of £86,000, Department for Science, Innovation & Technology contributes £24,914 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\)](#).

## BENEFITS

Whatever your role, we take your career and development seriously, and want to enable you to build a really successful career with the Department and wider Civil Service. It is crucial that our employees have the right skills to develop their careers and meet the challenges ahead.

You will benefit from a wide range of training and development opportunities, regular performance and development reviews to ensure this development is ongoing. As a Civil Service employee, you will be entitled to a large range of benefits. This includes:

## **Annual Leave and Bank Holiday Allowance**

25 days annual leave on entry, increasing on a sliding scale to 30 days after 5 years' service. This is in addition to 8 public holidays and one day's leave for the King's birthday.

## **Pension**

A competitive contributory pension scheme that you can enter as soon as you join where we will make a significant contribution to the cost of your pension; where your contributions come out of your salary before any tax is taken; and where your pension will continue to provide valuable benefits for you and your family if you are too ill to continue to work or die before you retire.

## **Flexible Working**

Flexible working patterns and access to Flexible Working Schemes allowing you to vary your working day as long as you work your total hours.

## **Parental Leave**

Generous paid maternity and paternity leave which is notably more than the statutory minimum offered by many other employers.

## **Season Ticket & Bicycle Loan**

Interest-free loans allowing you to spread the cost of an annual travel season ticket or a new bicycle.

## **Onsite Facilities**

The opportunity to use onsite facilities including staff canteens (where applicable).

## **Sick Pay**

Occupational sick pay.

## **Office attendance**

The Department operates a discretionary hybrid working policy, which provides for a combination of working hours from your place of work and from your home in the UK. The current expectation for staff is to attend the office or non-home based location for 40-60% of the time over the accounting period. Senior Civil Servant (SCS) staff are expected to aim for closer to 60% of the time at an office or non-home based location over the accounting period.

Any move to DSIT from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may, however, be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at: <https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk>

## Things you need to know

### **Artificial intelligence**

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

### **Selection process details**

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours and Experience.

### **1. SHORTLIST**

Applications will be sifted to select those demonstrating the best fit with the post against the criteria set out in the person specification. Please ensure you keep this in mind when writing your CV and personal statement.

Please ensure your **CV** is a maximum of **2 A4** pages and your personal statement does not exceed **1,250** words.

The timeline later in this pack indicates the date by which a decision is expected to be made, and all candidates will be advised of the outcome as soon as possible thereafter.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview.

## **2. INTERVIEW**

Shortlisted candidates will be invited to attend a panel interview to have a more in-depth discussion of your previous experience and professional competence in relation to the criteria set out in the Person Specification.

As part of the process there may be assessment of skills either by a presentation or simulated exercise with follow up questions. Full details of the requirements will be given to shortlisted candidates ahead of their interview.

Behaviours being assessed at interview are:

**Leadership**

**Delivering at Pace**

**Making Effective Decisions**

**Changing and Improving**

## **3. SELECTION AND FEEDBACK**

Regardless of the outcome, we will notify all candidates as soon as possible, and will offer the opportunity to discuss feedback for all candidates who

reached interview. A reserve list will be held for up to 12 months, which we may use to fill future suitable vacancies.

## **Expected Time Line**

We will try and offer as much flexibility as we can, but it may not be possible to offer alternative dates for assessments or interviews. You are therefore asked to note the below timetable, exercising flexibility through the recruitment and selection process, to meet the dates given. Please note that these dates are only indicative may be subject to change. If you anticipate any difficulties attending, please alert [scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk](mailto:scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk) upon application.

The anticipated timetable is as follows:

Advert closing date **23:55 Monday 12th October 2026**

Shortlist **W/C 19th October 2026**

Panel interviews **W/C 26th October 2026**

It is expected that interviews will be conducted in-person in **22 Whitehall, London**, however this will be confirmed during the shortlisting process and successful candidates will be informed accordingly.

## **Further Information**

### **CONFLICTS OF INTEREST**

Candidates must note the requirement to declare any interests they may have that might cause questions to be raised about their approach to the business of the Department. They are required to declare any relevant business interests, shareholdings, positions of authority, retainers, consultancy arrangements or other connections with commercial, public or voluntary bodies, both for themselves and for their spouses/partners. The successful candidate will be required to give up any conflicting interests and his/her other business and financial interests may be published.

### **SECURITY CLEARANCE**

Before the appointment of the successful candidate can be confirmed, the Department will undertake background security checks. As part of this, we will need to confirm your identity, employment history over the past three years (or course details if you were in education), nationality and immigration status, and criminal record (unspent convictions only).

This role will require the postholder to have **Developed Vetting (DV)** clearance, therefore successful candidates will be expected to either hold this or be willing to undertake the DV clearance process once in post. More information can be found [here](#).

## **RESERVED FOR UK NATIONALS**

Certain posts, notably those concerned with security and intelligence, might be reserved for British citizens, but this will not normally prevent access to a wide range of developmental opportunities within the Civil Service.

### **This is a reserved post.**

Former DSIT recruitment campaigns are continuing as usual, but candidates should be aware that following the Government's announcement on the changes to some civil service departments, roles will be subject to the machinery of government moves and will ultimately be in one of the new departments. We will provide more information if you are selected for a role. This work remains of high importance to the civil service, and we thank you for your continued interest.

## **Reasonable Adjustment**

We are proud to be a disability confident leader and we welcome applications from disabled candidates and candidates with long-term conditions.

Information about the Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) and some examples of adjustments that we offer to disabled candidates and candidates with long-term health conditions during our recruitment process can be found in our [DSIT Candidate Guidance](#). A [DSIT Plain Text Version](#) of the guidance is also available.

We encourage candidates to discuss their adjustment needs by emailing the job contact which can be found under the contact point for applicants section.

If you are experiencing accessibility problems with any attachments on this advert, please contact the email address in the 'Contact point for applicants' section.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

This role has a minimum assignment duration of 1 year. An assignment duration is the period of time a Senior Civil Servant is expected to remain in the same post to enable them to deliver on the agreed key business outcomes. The assignment duration also supports your career through building your depth of expertise.

As part of accepting this role you will be agreeing to the expected assignment duration set out above. This will not result in a contractual change to your terms and conditions. Please note this is an expectation only, it is not something which is written into your terms and conditions or indeed which the employing organisation or you are bound by. It will depend on your personal circumstances at a particular time and business needs, for example, would not preclude any absence like family friendly leave. It is nonetheless an important expectation, which is why we ask you to confirm you agree to the assignment duration set out above.

## **Security**

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [developed vetting \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

## Nationality requirements

Open to UK nationals only.

## Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

## Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

## Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

## Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : SCS Recruitment Team

Email : [scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk](mailto:scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk)

Recruitment team

Email : [scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk](mailto:scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk)

## **Further information**

### COMPLAINTS

Civil Service Commission Selection for appointment to the Civil Service is on merit, response, fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles.

In accordance with the Civil Service Commissioners' Recruitment Principles, our recruitment and selection processes are underpinned by the requirement of appointment response, merit by fair and open competition. If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, in the first instance you should contact; [scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk](mailto:scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk). If you are not satisfied with the response, you receive you can contact the Civil Service Commission at [info@csc.gov.uk](mailto:info@csc.gov.uk) and more information can be found at [www.civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk](http://www.civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk)

